

DAL at HOU · Sunday 2026-10-04 13:00 ET · Week 4 2026

League-wide only. Window: weeks 4–9, 2015–2025. $n \geq 10$. No team streaks. No half-EPA. Lines from nflverse games.csv (snapshot Oct 1). Scores and team-week stats through Week 3; EPA from play-by-play.

Line: DAL +3.0 / HOU -3.0, total 48.5. Trip: DAL → HOU 225 mi, 0 time zones. Rest: DAL 7 days, HOU 7 days. Roof: nan.

1. Season boxes

Wk	Team	Spot	Score	Line	ATS	Off yds	Rush	Pass EPA	Off EPA	Def EPA allowed	SR	TO
1	DAL	A at NYG	20–28	–3.0	miss	244	69	+10.4	+15.7	+23.9	0.48	1
2	DAL	H vs WAS	37–20	–3.5	cover	345	66	+15.1	+12.7	+2.2	0.56	0
3	DAL	N vs BAL	31–34	+3.0	push	424	148	+13.3	+8.6	+12.6	0.47	1
1	HOU	H vs BUF	31–36	+1.5	miss	398	124	+1.5	+5.6	+15.6	0.48	2
2	HOU	H vs CIN	6–20	–3.0	miss	413	60	–9.7	–18.9	–6.3	0.34	0
3	HOU	A at IND	17–19	–1.5	miss	237	70	–3.1	–4.5	–8.1	0.43	0

Last game EPA (PBP): DAL off +8.6, def allowed +12.6, net -3.9, SR 0.47. HOU off -4.5, def allowed -8.1, net +3.6, SR 0.43. Records: DAL 1–2, HOU 0–3. ATS: DAL 1–1, HOU 0–3.

2. Lookahead and rest

- DAL: last played week 3 (Sunday late window, neutral site, lost by 3). 7 days rest. Week 5: home vs TB, non-division, Thursday night.
- HOU: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, road, lost by 2). 7 days rest. Week 5: road vs TEN, division, Sunday early window.

3. Sides — HOU -3.0

HOU (home favorite)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
home favorite	265–294–16	47.4%	575
Sunday early window home favorite	145–150–10	49.2%	305
home fav -1 to -3	85–100–9	45.9%	194
Sunday early window fav -1 to -3	102–106–10	49.0%	218

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
equal rest, home fav -1 to -3	43–65–5	39.8%	113
off an ATS miss, home favorite	112–144–8	43.8%	264
off an ATS miss, Sunday early window home favorite	53–75–5	41.4%	133
off a 1-score loss, home favorite	61–84–3	42.1%	148
off a loss, home favorite	111–141–6	44.0%	258
rush yards ≤75 last, Sunday early window home favorite	21–35	37.5%	56
off yards ≤250 last, Sunday early window home favorite	6–14–1	30.0%	21
off a 1-score loss, home fav -1 to -3	21–34–2	38.2%	57
off a loss, home fav -1 to -3	40–57–5	41.2%	102
rush yards ≤75 last, home favorite	47–65–4	42.0%	116
off a 1-score loss, Sunday early window home favorite	27–41–2	39.7%	70
off a loss, Sunday early window home favorite	55–73–3	43.0%	131
off an ATS miss, home fav -1 to -3	38–52–6	42.2%	96
equal rest, home favorite	154–180–10	46.1%	344
next game is road, home favorite	179–206–8	46.5%	393
lost last despite net EPA ≥ +1, home fav -1 to -3	7–3	70.0%	10
off EPA ≤ -1 last, Sunday early window home favorite	48–60–3	44.4%	111
next game is road, home fav -1 to -3	57–70–4	44.9%	131

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
opponent off a loss, home favorite	142–162–7	46.7%	311
off a road game, Sunday early window fav –1 to –3	47–58–7	44.8%	112
off yards ≤300 last, Sunday early window home favorite	25–33–3	43.1%	61
next game is division, Sunday early window fav –1 to –3	26–34	43.3%	60
both off a loss, home fav –1 to –3	21–28–3	42.9%	52
off a 1-score loss, Sunday early window fav –1 to –3	22–29–2	43.1%	53
next game is division, home favorite	84–97–1	46.4%	182
off yards ≤250 last, Sunday early window fav –1 to –3	7–11–1	38.9%	19
both off a loss, home favorite	67–78–4	46.2%	149
next game is division, home fav –1 to –3	26–33	44.1%	59

Wide populations (n ≥ 300): equal rest, home favorite, next game is road, home favorite, opponent off a loss, home favorite. They describe the spot, they do not select this game.

4. Sides — DAL +3.0

Mirror of the chair above. Same games, other side.

DAL (road dog)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
road dog	294–265–16	52.6%	575
Sunday early window road dog	150–145–10	50.8%	305
road dog +1 to +3	100–85–9	54.1%	194
Sunday early window dog +1 to +3	106–102–10	51.0%	218

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off EPA ≥ +8 last, road dog +1 to +3	40–19	67.8%	59
trip 200–1000 mi, road dog	179–135–6	57.0%	320
pass EPA ≥ +10 last, road dog +1 to +3	33–16	67.3%	49
trip 200–1000 mi, Sunday early window dog +1 to +3	41–22–2	65.1%	65
TO ≤1 last, road dog +1 to +3	75–49–5	60.5%	129
pass EPA ≥ +10 last, Sunday early window road dog	38–21–2	64.4%	61
pass EPA ≥ +10 last, road dog	61–39–2	61.0%	102
next game is prime time, road dog	58–37–2	61.1%	97
trip 200–1000 mi, road dog +1 to +3	64–42–3	60.4%	109
equal rest, road dog +1 to +3	65–43–5	60.2%	113
off EPA ≥ +8 last, road dog	77–54–1	58.8%	132
opponent off an ATS miss, road dog	144–112–8	56.2%	264
opponent off an ATS miss, Sunday early window road dog	75–53–5	58.6%	133
scored ≥30 last, road dog +1 to +3	34–20–2	63.0%	56
trip 200–1000 mi, Sunday early window road dog	107–81–3	56.9%	191
opponent off a loss, road dog	141–111–6	56.0%	258
next game is prime time, road dog +1 to +3	24–13	64.9%	37
opponent off a loss, road dog +1 to +3	57–40–5	58.8%	102
next game is prime time, Sunday early window road dog	32–20–1	61.5%	53
lost last despite off EPA ≥ +1, road dog	44–30–2	59.5%	76
opponent off a loss, Sunday early window road dog	73–55–3	57.0%	131
scored ≥30 last, road dog	75–57–5	56.8%	137
off EPA ≥ +8 last, Sunday early window road dog	42–29–1	59.2%	72

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off a 1-score loss, road dog	88–69–5	56.1%	162
TO ≤1 last, road dog	177–150–7	54.1%	334
opponent off an ATS miss, road dog +1 to +3	52–38–6	57.8%	96
next game is Thursday (short week ahead), road dog	15–8–1	65.2%	24
equal rest, road dog	180–154–10	53.9%	344

Wide populations (n ≥ 300): trip 200–1000 mi, road dog, TO ≤1 last, road dog, equal rest, road dog. They describe the spot, they do not select this game.

5. Total 48.5

Cut	Over–Under	Over pct	n
Sunday early window, line within 3, total 45–49	44–32	57.9%	76
line within 3, total 45–49	75–61–1	55.1%	137
Sunday early window, total 45–49	106–90–1	54.1%	197
Sunday early window, total ≥47	93–81–3	53.4%	177
Sunday early window	267–249–5	51.7%	521
line within 3, total ≥47	63–71–3	47.0%	137
total ≥47	167–179–5	48.3%	351
total 45–49	187–175–2	51.7%	364
line within 3	185–194–5	48.8%	384
Sunday early window, line within 3	107–110–2	49.3%	219
Sunday early window, line within 3, total ≥47	37–37–1	50.0%	75

6. What does not apply

- 2+ time-zone trip: no
- double-digit dog: no
- off a 10-point loss: no
- off a 20-point win: no
- 2nd straight home game: no
- 2nd straight road game: no
- bye next week: no
- off a bye: no
- scored ≤10 last: no
- short week: no
- trip ≥1000 mi: no
- TO ≥3 last: no
- undefeated entering: no
- winless entering: no

7. Stack, without double-counting

Stack floor is n ≥ 20 (tables use n ≥ 10). Traits are added by largest parent-minus-child gap (the stack's pct against the pct of the games the trait removes), not by a fixed order. Under each stack: by-season W-L, cover-margin quartiles with signed tails, parent-minus-child (the stack without each trait, and the games that trait removed), the anchor's complement, the stack split by line bucket, a contrary cross (the team's own traits that run against it on the anchor, crossed into the stack), and a hold-out (traits chosen on 2015–20 only, printed on 2021–25).

- **HOU –3.0** — one population: home fav –1 to –3; equal rest; off a loss as favorite. ATS 12–9 (57.1%, n=21). Not added (no gap with n ≥ 20 left): off a loss, off a 1-score loss, off an ATS miss, off a road game, off a division game, scored ≤17 last, scored ≤21 last, allowed ≤21 last....
- By season: 16:2-0 17:0-1 18:0-1 19:1-0 20:1-1 21:1-2 22:3-2 23:1-1 24:1-0 25:2-1
- Cover margin: median +4.5, q25/q75 -9.5/+11.0; P(>+7) 0.33, P(<-7) 0.33
- Parent minus child: without 'equal rest': 16–14–1 (53.3%, n=31), the games it removed: 4–5–1 (44.4%, n=10) | without 'off a loss as favorite': 43–65–5 (39.8%, n=113), the games it removed: 31–56–5 (35.6%, n=92)
- Anchor alone 85–100–9 (45.9%, n=194); anchor minus stack 73–91–9 (44.5%, n=173)

- Stack by line bucket: -1 to -3 12-9 (57.1%, n=21)
- Contrary cross (team's own traits that run against it on this anchor, then crossed into the stack): off a 1-score loss: 21-34-2 (38.2%, n=57) → in stack 7-6 (53.8%, n=13) | off a loss: 40-57-5 (41.2%, n=102) → in stack 12-9 (57.1%, n=21) | off an ATS miss: 38-52-6 (42.2%, n=96) → in stack 12-9 (57.1%, n=21) | next game is road: 57-70-4 (44.9%, n=131) → in stack 9-5 (64.3%, n=14)
- Hold-out (traits chosen on 2015-20 only: home fav -1 to -3; opponent off a loss; equal rest; off a road game): 2015-20 5-13-2 (27.8%, n=20) → 2021-25 7-10 (41.2%, n=17)
- **DAL +3.0** — one population: road dog +1 to +3; off EPA $\geq$ +8 last; TO $\leq$ 1 last; next game is home non-division. ATS 14-10 (58.3%, n=24). Not added (no gap with n $\geq$ 20 left): equal rest, trip 200-1000 mi, 0 time zones, off a loss, off a 1-score loss, off a loss as dog, off a neutral-site game, scored 27-33 last...
- By season: 16:2-0 18:2-0 19:2-1 20:2-0 21:1-1 22:0-2 23:1-2 24:3-1 25:1-3
- Cover margin: median +2.0, q25/q75 -7.0/+6.2; P(>+7) 0.25, P(<-7) 0.25
- Parent minus child: without 'off EPA $\geq$ +8 last': 32-26 (55.2%, n=58), the games it removed: 18-16 (52.9%, n=34) | without 'TO $\leq$ 1 last': 15-12 (55.6%, n=27), the games it removed: 1-2 (33.3%, n=3) | without 'next game is home non-division': 38-16 (70.4%, n=54), the games it removed: 24-6 (80.0%, n=30)
- Anchor alone 100-85-9 (54.1%, n=194); anchor minus stack 86-75-9 (53.4%, n=170)
- Stack by line bucket: +1 to +3 14-10 (58.3%, n=24)
- Contrary cross (team's own traits that run against it on this anchor, then crossed into the stack): allowed $\geq$ 30 last: 16-22-2 (42.1%, n=40) → in stack 2-1 (66.7%, n=3) | allowed $\geq$ 27 last: 29-31-2 (48.3%, n=62) → in stack 5-2 (71.4%, n=7) | off a loss as dog: 24-25-2 (49.0%, n=51) → in stack 2-0 (100.0%, n=2)
- Hold-out (traits chosen on 2015-20 only: road dog +1 to +3; off EPA $\geq$ +8 last; off yards $\geq$ 400 last): 2015-20 16-4 (80.0%, n=20) → 2021-25 10-10 (50.0%, n=20)
- **Total 48.5, tightest cut clearing n = 20:** Sunday early window, line within 3, total 45-49 — O-U 44-32 (57.9%, n=76).
- By season (O-U): 15:2-2 16:9-3 17:3-3 18:7-5 19:6-2 20:0-3 21:6-4 22:3-6 23:1-1 24:3-2 25:4-1
- Total margin (points - line): median +2.8, q25/q75 -8.0/+10.1; P(>+7) 0.34, P(<-7) 0.26
- By total band: 45-49 44-32 (n=76)

Feeds: nflverse games.csv (lines, scores, rest), stats_team_week 2015-2026 (yards, pass EPA, TO), play_by_play 2015-2026 (off/def EPA, success rate), data/airports.csv (miles, zones).